

European Chemicals

Air Liquide SA

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

AI.FP

192.00 EUR



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Air Liquide: 2026 CMD Preview - An opportunity created by moderate expectations

Air Liquide's 5th October CMD has been flying slightly under the radar, in our view. With Air Liquide's stock mostly drifting since their 1H26 update, we believe the event will provide a timely reminder of the quality of the business model and provide support to our thesis of accelerating growth (see report [Air Liquide: Mapping the future project growth potential](#)). Although we expect strategic evolution rather than revolution, we see risk-reward as positive ahead of the event. We reiterate our Outperform rating.

Evolution, not revolution, from the strategy. The CMD has been billed as the introduction of the new strategic plan, to replace [2022's ADVANCE strategy](#). We expect a presentation detailing the next phase of growth and margin improvement. We do not expect a major change from the previous strategy of driving efficiencies in a form of [the industrial gas density and discipline model](#), but rather examples of the next sources of cost savings and a greater focus on the growth opportunities available to Air Liquide, particularly in electronics. We also believe that anything that Air Liquide announces they will be aiming to exceed, similarly to how ADVANCE's initial +160bps margin improvement target eventually became +320bps.

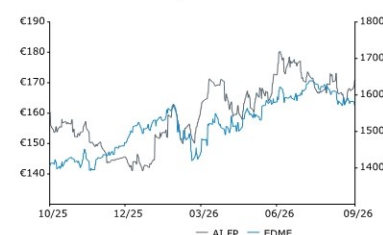
What targets we expect from Air Liquide... We now expect +400bps of margin improvement over 2027-30, given slower than +100bps per annum would be a backwards step and is well underwritten by our own +435bps modelling. We also expect improvements to ROCE (12.5%+ by 2030), lower emissions intensity and an ADR. We remain hopeful for higher capital returns; our analysis tells us that Air Liquide could both increase capex to from c. 14% sales to 16% sales and return €10bn more capital while keeping leverage under 2.0x in 2030. However, we are cautious around a formal growth target, but a return to ramp-up disclosure is on our wish list.

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Close Date	30 Sep 2026			
AI.FP Close Price (EUR)	170.88			
Price Target (EUR)	192.00			
Upside/(Downside)	12%			
52-Week Range	182.26/140.78			
EDME	1,573.97			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	2.0%			
Market Cap (EUR) (M)	108,373			
EV (EUR) (M)	124,316			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	16.6	(1.9)	3.8	6.2
EDME (%)	7.0	(2.0)	6.2	12.3
Relative (%)	9.5	0.0	(2.4)	(6.1)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	25A	26E	27E
AI.FP (EUR)	6.07	6.51	7.17	EBIT (M)	5,279	5,837	6,560	--	Reported P/E (x)	30.9	28.6	25.1
				Dividend/Share	3.70	3.96	4.24	--				

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

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... and where we think the market is: In our conversations with investors, we believe margin expectations probably need to be higher than our previous expectations of 300-350bps over 2027-2030, and ROCE needs to keep improving, but there is some slightly broader scepticism over if there will be a revenue / profit growth target or any major changes to capital allocation policy. This does not diminish investor perceptions of Air Liquide's potential - we have fielded many questions about the margin gap versus Linde in recent weeks - and again we believe Air Liquide are only likely to set targets they have a high degree of confidence they can deliver. But we do believe expectations are therefore not excessive.

Therefore, from a trading perspective we see CMD risk-reward skewed positively.

While Air Liquide has slightly outperformed their industrial gas and European chemicals peers over the last month and since the [FT broke the news about Elliott Management taking a stake](#), +1% absolute share price performance indicates only moderate enthusiasm. Expectations of conservatism from Air Liquide mean that a slight miss to our expected headlines are not likely cause the stock to crash, in our view. And the presence of Elliott on the shareholder register could lead to upside versus margin target expectations or more shareholder-friendly capital return policies, even if other targets are more in-line.

Investment Implications

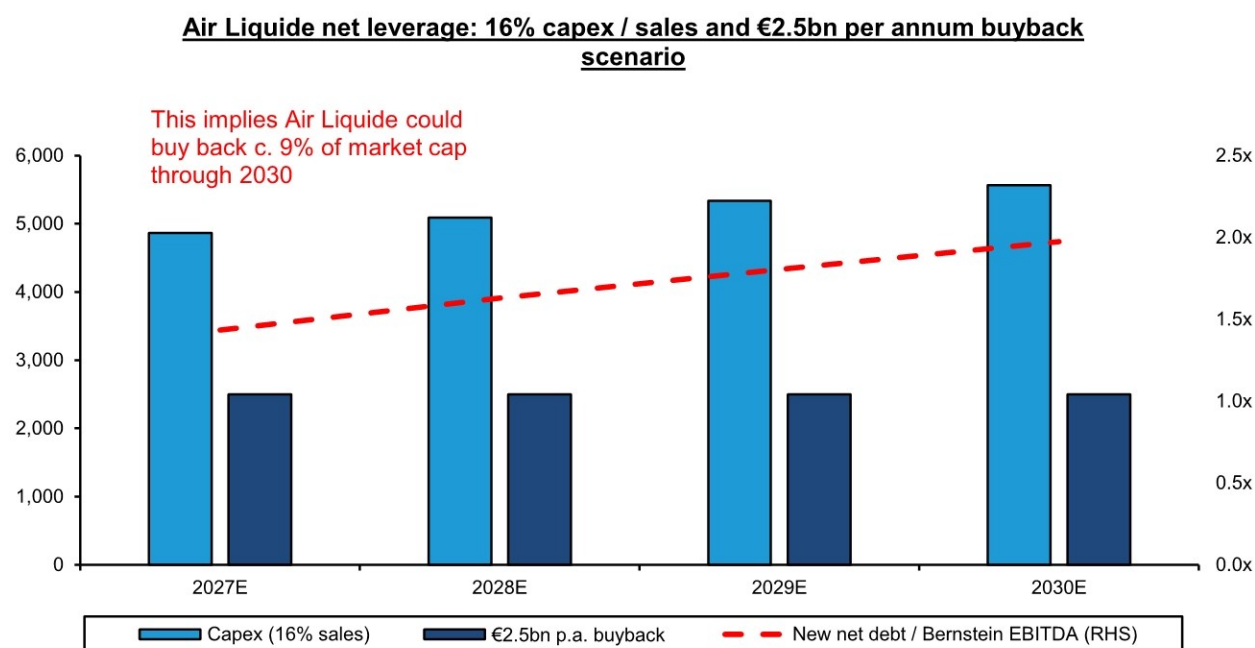
We rate Air Liquide Outperform. We make no changes to our estimates. On an unchanged valuation methodology (28x NTM P/E), our price target remains €192.

DETAILS

OUR DETAILED VIEW ON AIR LIQUIDE'S LIKELY TARGETS

- **We now expect +100bps of annual margin improvement through 2030, i.e. +400bps in 2027-30.** We have become slightly more bullish since [our deep dive into Air Liquide's project](#) pipeline, where we estimated +300-350bps over 2027-2030. Given that the company guided to +200bps of total margin improvement over 2026 and 2027, a subsequent slowdown we believe would be seen as a backward step when the gap to Linde remains substantial in our view. And we believe +400bps is supported by our own modelling of +435bps over 2027-30, given the ongoing pricing opportunity, the profitability per employee lag and other the project ramp-up, particularly in electronics.
- **ROCE to increase slightly (e.g. >12.5% in 2030).**
- **Emissions intensity reductions**, albeit perhaps not an absolute decline given the expected growth.
- **Higher capital returns, potentially including a buyback.** We believe from [Exhibit 1](#) that there is ample room to increase expected capex / sales to 16%, begin a c. €2.5bn buyback per annum and maintain net leverage below 2.0x EBITDA through 2030. In our view, this is more shareholder friendly but does not jeopardise Air Liquide's growth potential.
- **We don't expect Air Liquide to give a revenue / profit growth target in the vein of ADVANCE's 5-6% comparable growth CAGR. But a quantification of ramp-up growth is on our wish list.** Air Liquide have in general been reluctant to give revenue targets recently given the uncertainty around base volumes, but with plenty of contracted projects expected to hit the P&L in the coming years, we see room for a target in the being of c. 1.5% per annum project contribution to comparable growth through 2030, as per our note [Air Liquide: Mapping the future project growth potential](#), which alongside pricing would form the bulk of the revenue growth needed to deliver very solid net income growth.
- **An ADR** could also be an easy win to drive US liquidity, given Air Liquide's \$100bn+ market value.

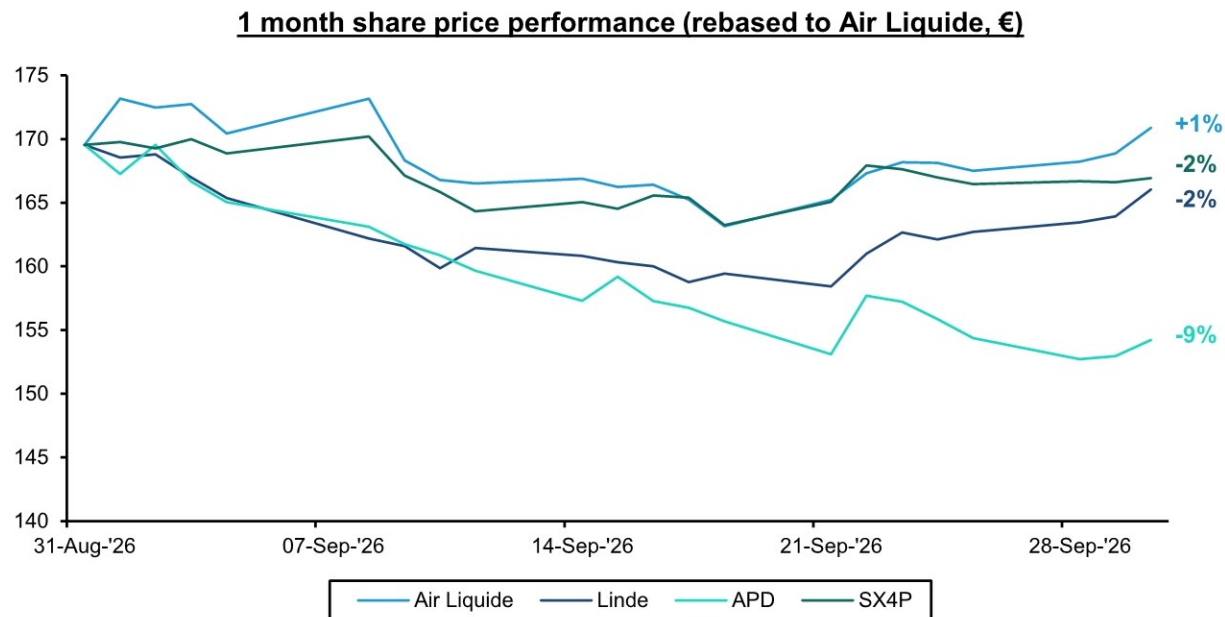
EXHIBIT 1: **Even increasing capex from 14% to 16% of revenues to pay for growth, we believe there is ample room to return capital**



Source: Company information, Bernstein estimates and analysis

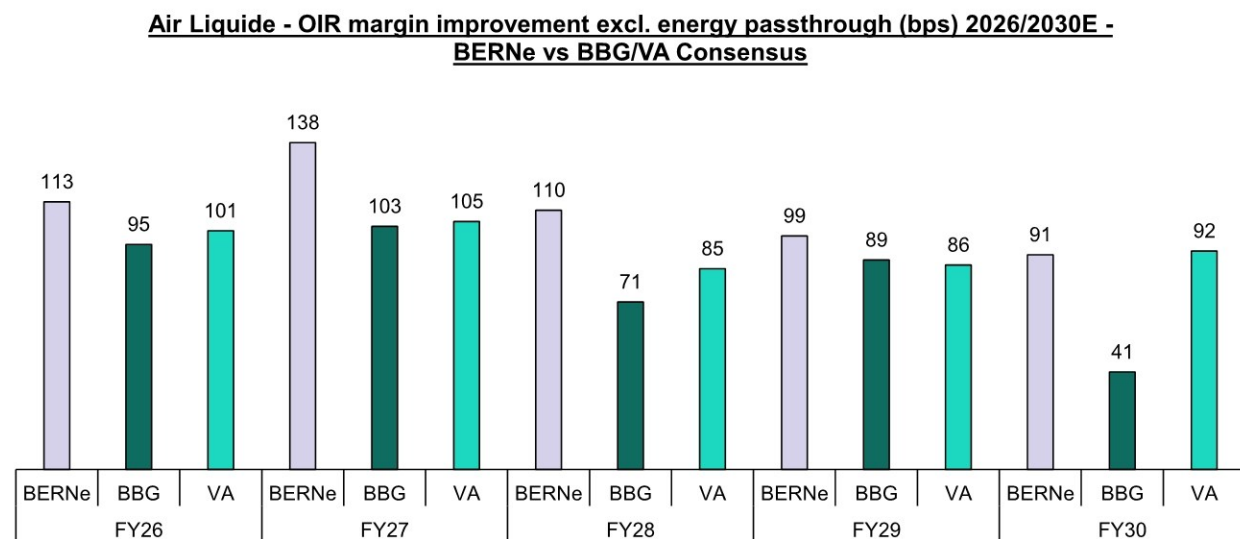
SUPPORTING EXHIBITS

EXHIBIT 2: Air Liquide's recent share price performance does not indicate elevated expectations, even if it has slightly outperformed

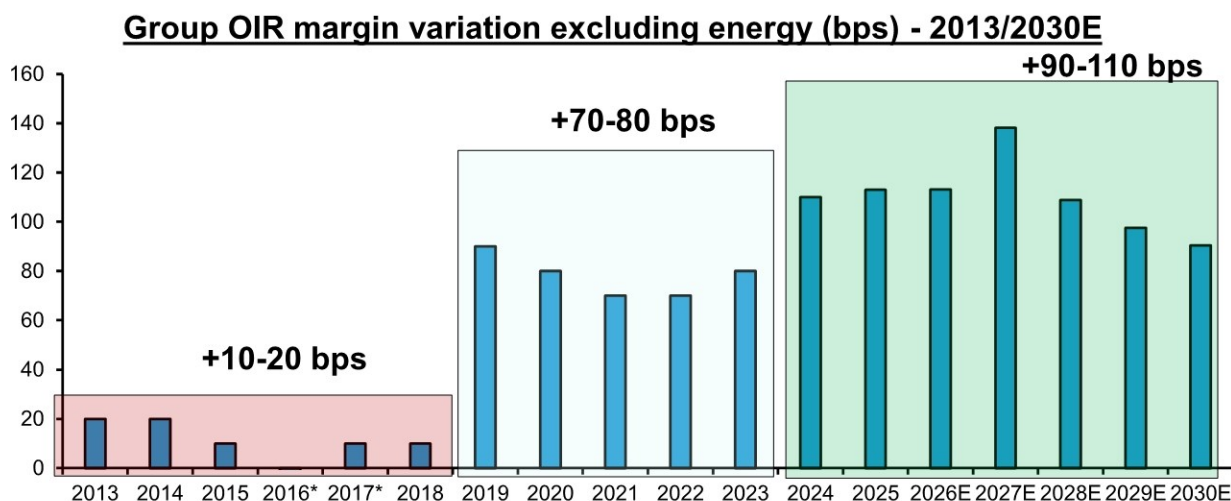


Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: We see around 100bps of margin improvement per annum with a stronger uplift in 2027



Source: Company information, Bloomberg, Visible Alpha, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 4: **We see peak OIR improvement in 2027 before settling at a high level of c.100bps**

Source: Company information, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 5: **We see only c.165bps difference of margins between Air Liquide and Linde which are structural / choices we see as unlikely to be unwound**

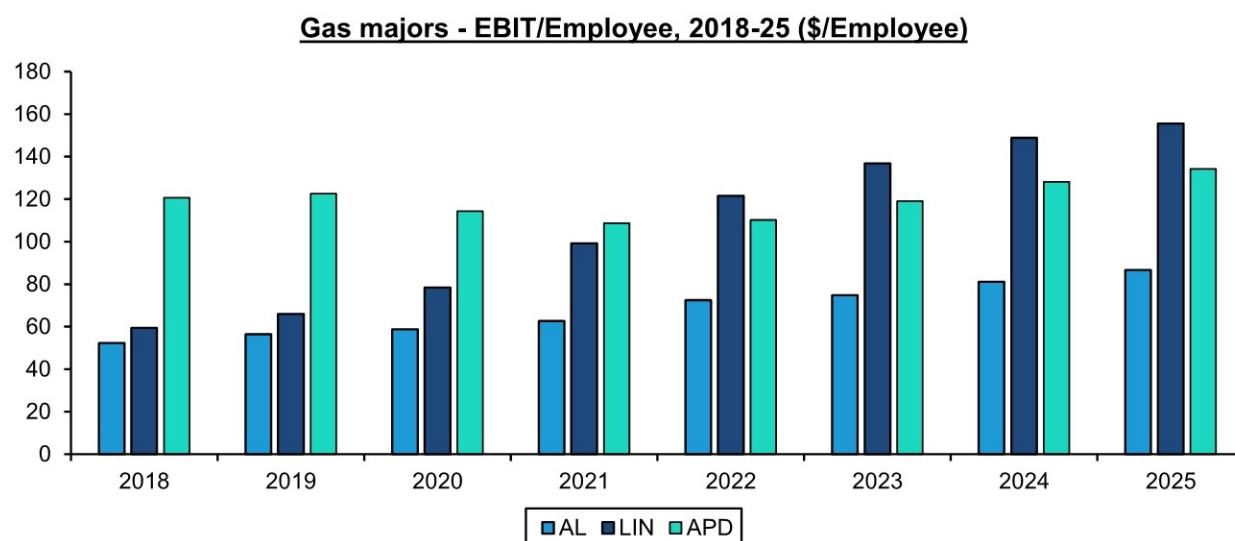
Air Liquide vs. Linde: Margin Analysis		
	Air Liquide	Linde
2018 Recurring Group EBIT Margin	16.4%	17.1%
2022 Recurring Group EBIT Margin	16.2%	23.7%
Improvement vs. 2018	-17 bps	661 bps
2025 Recurring Group EBIT Margin	20.7%	29.8%
2026 BernE Recurring Group EBIT Margin	21.2%	30.0%
Improvement vs. 2018	476 bps	1,288 bps
Improvement vs. 2022	493 bps	627 bps
Gap analysis		
26E Group EBIT Margin Gap vs. Linde	879 bps	
Acquisition Amortisation Accounting	-54 bps	
R&D Spend	-34 bps	
Higher energy pass through	-76 bps	
26E Gap - Comparable	715 bps	
Implied Structural Margin Difference	-164 bps	

Source: Company information, Bernstein analysis and estimates

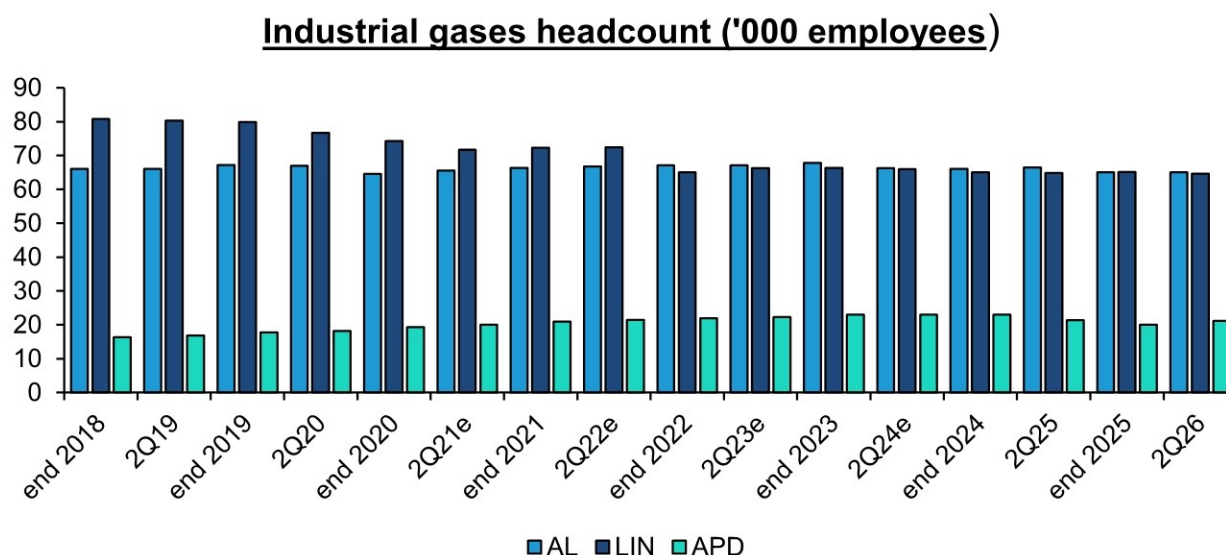
EXHIBIT 6: **We see more potential for margin improvement at Air Liquide, but also a long runway at Linde**

Air Liquide vs. Linde: Margin Potential		
	Air Liquide	Linde
Profit Mix		
Gases	97.0%	95.0%
Engineering	1.0%	4.0%
Other	2.0%	1.0%
Recurring EBIT Margin Potential		
Gases	32.5%	36.0%
Engineering	15.0%	25.0%
Other	25.0%	10.0%
Group	32.2%	35.3%
Potential Improvement	1,100 bps	534 bps
Time to Reach Potential		
Est. -ve Volume Operating Leverage Impact	-158 bps	-180 bps
Margin with Normalised Volumes	22.7%	31.8%
Remaining BPS vs. Potential	943 bps	354 bps
Linde midpoint annual margin improvement target	40 bps	40 bps
Implied Years of margin improvement	24	9

Source: Company information, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 7: **Air Liquide has improved EBIT/Employee, but Linde has been quicker**

Source: Company information, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 8: **Linde has been more aggressive than peers on headcount reduction**

Source: Company information, Bernstein analysis and estimates

KEY INDUSTRIAL GASES RESEARCH**INDUSTRIAL GASES**

- 15 Jul 2026 - [Chemicals: Specialty or Commodity, with potentially tough times in between](#)
- 26 May 2026 - [The Long View: Chemicals - Analysing the lasting impact on upstream chemicals of the Iran war](#)
- 07 May 2026 - [The Bernstein Industrial Gases Primer: How the industry structure can support long-term outperformance](#)
- 20 Apr 2026 - [Chemicals: Positioning for an Iran-related cycle and upgrading Arkema to Market-Perform](#)
- 13 Mar 2026 - [Global Industrial Gases & Semis: Assessing the helium impact](#)
- 23 Feb 2026 - [The Long View: The Industrial Gas space opportunity - rocket fuel for growth](#)
- 08 Jan 2026 - [Chemicals Outlook 2026: A slow start, but there could be considerable upside potential. Downgrading Solvay to Market-Perform.](#)
- 01 Dec 2025 - [The Long View: How Industrial Gases revenues can compound at the magic 5% through 2030](#)
- 13 Aug 2025 - [European Chemicals: War and Peace II - Refreshing our Ukraine war scenarios](#)
- 27 May 2025 - [Chemicals: Amongst the tariff turmoil](#)
- 9 April 2025 - [Industrial Gas Majors - It's a big world, after all but gases don't travel so "Hold Tough" and Buy](#)

AIR LIQUIDE

- 16 Sep 2026 - [Air Liquide: Mapping the future project growth potential](#)
- 31 Aug 2026 - [Quick Take: Air Liquide reportedly sees activist stake-building](#)
- 29 Jul 2026 - [Air Liquide 1H26 - Speed bump, but remain Outperform](#)

- 29 Apr 2026 - [Air Liquide 1Q26: Who is the guidance for?](#)
- 23 Feb 2026 - [Air Liquide 2H25: More growth and more margin improvement](#)
- 28 Jan 2026 - [Air Liquide: Best European Idea First Quarter 2026 – Improving growth that isn't priced in. Outperform](#)
- 03 Dec 2025 - [Quick Take: A day with Air Liquide at the SDC Premium Review](#)
- 29 Oct 2025 - [Air Liquide 3Q25: Typically solid, and potentially the growth trough](#)
- 25 Sep 2025 - [Air Liquide at the Bernstein European Industrials Forum: Reassuringly Consistent](#)
- 22 Aug 2025 - [Quick Take: Air Liquide acquires DIG Airgas - a high price, but a worthy purchase](#)
- 30 Jul 2025 - [Air Liquide 1H25: "This is just the beginning"](#)
- 28 Jul 2025 - [Air Liquide: Marginal Gains](#)
- 29 May 2025 - [Quick Take: Air Liquide Americas CEO at the SDC](#)
- 24 April 2025 - [Air Liquide - Steady as she goes](#)
- 21 February 2025 - [Air Liquide - Pushing the margin again....](#)
- 14 February 2025 - [Air Liquide- We see the FY24 EBIT margin +110bp and scope for c.500bp more from there](#)

LINDE

- 11 Sep 2026 - [Linde: Mapping the future project growth potential](#)
- 19 Aug 2026 - [Linde's Lincare issue: It's a problem, but it's more than priced in](#)
- 3 Aug 2026 - [Linde 2Q26 - Earnings Aristocrat, and a buying opportunity](#)
- 05 May 2026 - [Linde 1Q26: Earnings Aristocrat, and potentially improving core growth](#)
- 19 Feb 2026 - [Linde 4Q25: Earnings Aristocrat, and well positioned for all macro scenarios](#)
- 3 Nov 2025 - [Linde 3Q25: Earnings Aristocrat, but also an underappreciated growth story](#)
- 31 Oct 2025 - [Quick Take: Linde 3Q25 - 27 Adj. EPS beats in a row, but a guidance narrow rather than raise](#)
- 4 Aug 2025 - [Linde 2Q25: Earnings Aristocrat](#)
- 1 Aug 2025 - [Quick Take: Linde 2Q25 - 26 EPS beats in a row, and what's 3 cents between friends?](#)
- 22 July 2025 - [Linde: Earnings aristocrat 2Q25 - we see the 26th quarter of consecutive EPS beats](#)
- 4 Jun 2025 - [Linde: A day with the CEO at the SDC - "The value is visible" ... in the field, networks, density, benchmarking, ownership, 45Q...](#)
- 29 Apr 2025 - [Linde: Earnings Aristocrat? 1Q25 - we see the 25th quarter of consecutive EPS beat and underlying sequential growth](#)
- 6 February 2025 - [Linde - As expected the 24th beat, 1Q and FY25 guidance light and a share reaction like with 3Q24...](#)
- 4 February 2025 - [Linde - We see the 24th consecutive EPS beat, and qoq growth but the macro drag on guidance, but...](#)

AIR PRODUCTS

- 31 Jul 2026 - [Air Products 3QFY26: Passing the duck test](#)
- 17 Jul 2026 - [Air Products: Sustainable above-consensus EPS growth, even including NEOM](#)
- 30 Jun 2026 - [Quick Take: Air Products cancels Darrow & 3QFY26 update](#)
- 27 May 2026 - [Bernstein SDC: Air Products Takeaways](#)
- 01 May 2026 - [Air Products 2QFY26: This may not be the last guidance raise of the year](#)
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- 31 January 2025 - [Air Products - Upgrading to outperform Density, discipline, de-risking...dependability?](#)

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 9: Air Liquide financial summary

Air Liquide (EURmn)	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
P&L																
Net sales	21,920	20,485	23,335	29,934	27,608	27,057	26,840	6,786	7,042	7,220	7,813	28,861	30,419	31,817	33,341	34,781
Gas & Services	21,040	19,656	22,267	28,573	26,360	25,809	26,085	6,596	6,812	7,004	7,579	27,990	29,531	30,911	32,416	33,838
E&C / E&T (from 2025)	328	250	387	474	390	412	855	190	230	216	235	871	888	906	924	943
Global Markets & Technology	552	579	681	887	858	836										
Other																
Total growth	4.3%	-6.5%	13.9%	28.3%	-7.8%	-2.0%	-0.4%	-3.4%	5.2%	9.4%	18.0%	7.1%	5.4%	4.6%	4.8%	4.3%
COGS	-8,154	-7,198	-9,389	-13,813	-11,147	-10,008	-9,651		-4,953		-5,279	-10,232	-10,333	-10,213	-10,382	-10,507
Gross profit	13,766	13,288	13,946	16,121	16,461	17,050	17,289		8,875		9,755	18,630	20,086	21,604	22,959	24,274
margin	62.8%	64.9%	59.8%	53.9%	59.6%	63.0%	64.2%		64.2%		64.9%	64.5%	66.0%	67.9%	68.9%	69.8%
Operating expenses	-8,022	-7,500	-7,764	-9,364	-9,407	-9,599	-9,447		-4,780		-5,251	-10,031	-10,550	-11,146	-11,663	-12,152
Operating income recurring before D&A	5,932	5,928	6,333	7,328	7,550	7,897	8,145		4,219		4,653	8,871	9,836	10,758	11,595	12,422
EBITDA	5,744	5,788	6,182	6,757	7,054	7,451	7,842		4,096		4,503	8,599	9,536	10,458	11,295	12,122
Depreciation and amortisation expense	-2,138	-2,138	-2,173	-2,466	-2,482	-2,505	-2,564		-1,325		-1,436	-2,761	-2,976	-3,234	-3,382	-3,539
Operating income recurring (OIR)	3,794	3,790	4,160	4,862	5,068	5,392	5,582		2,893		3,217	6,110	6,860	7,524	8,213	8,883
margin	17.3%	18.5%	17.8%	16.2%	18.36%	19.93%	20.72%		20.9%		21.4%	21.2%	22.6%	23.6%	24.6%	25.5%
EBIT	3,606	3,650	4,010	4,291	4,572	4,946	5,279		2,771		3,067	5,837	6,560	7,224	7,913	8,583
Financial income	-467	-444	-403	-385	-411	-419	-404		-209		-290	-499	-584	-610	-654	-699
Profit before tax	3,139	3,206	3,607	3,906	4,160	4,527	4,875		2,562		2,776	5,338	5,975	6,614	7,259	7,884
Income taxes	-802	-678	-915	-1,002	-972	-1,087	-1,231		-675		-731	-1,406	-1,508	-1,669	-1,832	-1,990
Profit for the period	2,338	2,528	2,692	2,904	3,188	3,440	3,644		1,887		2,045	3,932	4,467	4,944	5,426	5,894
Minorities	96	93	120	145	110	134	127		64		64	128	129	135	141	148
Net profit (group share)	2,242	2,435	2,572	2,759	3,078	3,306	3,518		1,823		1,981	3,804	4,338	4,810	5,285	5,746
margin	10.2%	11.9%	11.0%	9.2%	11.1%	12.2%	13.1%		13.2%		13.2%	13.2%	14.3%	15.1%	15.9%	16.5%
Basic EPS (€) (adj. for share count)	3.52	3.83	4.04	4.33	4.84	5.19	5.53		2.86		3.11	5.97	6.81	7.56	8.30	9.03
Adjusted EPS (€) (adj. for share count)	3.72	3.74	4.18	4.98	5.24	5.57	6.07		3.17		3.34	6.51	7.17	7.90	8.64	9.36
Adjusted EPS growth %		0.7%	11.6%	19.1%	5.3%	6.3%	9.0%		8.8%		5.9%	7.3%	10.1%	10.2%	9.4%	8.3%
Balance Sheet																
Cash & cash equivalents	1,026	1,882	2,331	1,953	1,720	1,919	4,342		2,153		4,569	4,569	6,428	8,804	11,326	14,055
Intangibles	15,498	14,485	15,445	16,399	15,826	16,669	15,386		18,220		18,220	18,220	18,220	18,220	18,220	18,220
Plant, property and equipment	21,118	20,003	22,532	23,647	23,652	25,539	24,910		26,538		27,206	27,206	28,454	29,759	31,133	32,556
Inventories and trade receivables	4,009	3,612	4,279	4,996	5,021	5,186	4,995		6,804		6,109	6,109	6,331	6,481	6,715	6,928
Other	2,016	1,995	2,197	2,524	2,113	2,555	2,281		2,562		2,650	2,650	2,612	2,661	2,714	2,764
Total Assets	43,667	41,977	46,783	49,518	48,332	51,868	51,913		56,278		58,755	58,755	62,046	65,925	70,108	74,524
Trade payables	2,567	2,438	3,333	3,783	3,311	3,319	3,004		3,274		3,591	3,591	3,549	3,712	3,890	4,058
Provisions	2,521	2,418	2,292	1,991	2,005	2,026	2,029		2,065		2,065	2,065	2,065	2,065	2,065	2,065
Borrowings	13,399	12,401	12,695	12,173	10,846	11,075	12,378		15,982		15,982	15,982	17,582	19,182	20,781	22,381
Other	5,855	5,677	6,427	6,984	7,084	7,826	7,477		7,666		7,888	7,888	7,920	8,049	8,189	8,322
Total liabilities	24,342	22,973	24,784	24,946	23,289	24,246	24,966		29,015		29,554	29,554	31,144	33,035	34,953	36,854
Total shareholders equity	19,324	19,005	21,999	24,572	25,043	27,622	26,947		27,263		29,201	29,201	30,902	32,889	35,155	37,670
Total equity and liabilities	43,667	41,977	46,783	49,518	48,332	51,868	51,913		56,278		58,755	58,755	62,046	65,925	70,108	74,524
Net debt	12,373	10,609	10,448	10,261	9,221	9,159	8,416		13,921		11,505	11,505	11,245	10,469	9,547	8,417
Net debt/OIR before D&A	2.1x	1.8x	1.6x	1.4x	1.2x	1.2x	1.0x		1.7x		1.3x	1.3x	1.1x	1.0x	0.8x	0.7x
ROIC (ex. intangibles)	14.8%	16.1%	16.4%	17.6%	18.3%	18.5%	18.4%		18.6%		18.7%	19.2%	19.8%	20.7%	21.6%	22.3%
ROCE (company defined)	8.6%	8.6%	9.3%	10.3%	10.6%	10.7%	11.2%					11.1%	11.6%	12.4%	13.2%	13.9%
Cash Flow Statement																
Cash and equivalents at start of period	1,549	896	1,719	2,139	1,761	1,404	1,303		3,678		1,805	3,678	4,221	6,037	8,369	10,847
Cash flows from operating activities (CFO)	4,712	5,206	5,571	5,810	6,263	6,322	6,518		1,954		4,564	6,518	7,236	8,137	8,698	9,322
Cash flows used in investing activities (CFI)	-2,585	-1,955	-3,352	-3,242	-3,079	-3,583	-3,751		-4,709		-2,105	-6,813	-4,340	-4,539	-4,756	-4,962
o/w purchases of PP&E and intangible asse	-2,636	-2,630	-2,917	-3,273	-3,393	-3,525	-3,843		-1,828		-2,105	-3,933	-4,340	-4,539	-4,756	-4,962
Cash flows from (used in) financing activities	-2,780	-2,428	-1,816	-2,781	-3,480	-2,808	-345		925		-43	882	-1,038	-1,222	-1,420	-1,631
Net increase (decrease) in cash flow	-653	824	404	-213	-296	-69	2,423		-1,829		2,416	587	1,859	2,376	2,522	2,729
FX and other	1	-1	17	-165	-62	-32	-47		-44		0	-44	-44	-44	-44	-44
Cash and equivalents at the end of the pe	896	1,719	2,139	1,761	1,404	1,303	3,678		1,805		4,221	4,221	6,037	8,369	10,847	13,532
Free cash flow to equity (Bernstein)	265	1,154	1,816	1,186	948	1,885	4,122		3,385		2,287	5,639	4,147	4,830	5,140	5,525
Free cash flow yield	0.6%	2.5%	3.9%	1.7%	1.1%	2.2%	4.5%		3.2%		2.2%	5.3%	3.9%	4.6%	4.9%	5.2%
Dividend yield	3.0%	3.0%	3.2%	2.2%	1.9%	2.2%	2.4%					2.4%	2.6%	2.7%	2.9%	3.1%
Dividend	2.45	2.49	2.63	2.95	3.20	3.30	3.70				3.96	4.24	4.53	4.85	5.19	
Dividend payout ratio	65.9%	66.6%	62.9%	59.3%	61.1%	59.2%	60.9%				60.8%	59.1%	57.4%	56.1%	55.4%	
Revenue Growth Drivers																
YoY Revenue Growth %	4.3%	-6.5%	13.9%	28.3%	-7.8%	-2.0%	-0.4%	-3.4%	5.2%	9.4%	18.0%	7.1%	5.4%	4.6%	4.8%	4.3%
Comparable Growth %	3.2%	-1.3%	8.2%	8.2%	3.7%	2.6%	1.8%	3.4%	3.7%	4.1%	3.3%	4.7%	4.6%	4.8%	4.3%	4.3%
Portfolio	0.5%	-1.4%	1.2%	15.6%	-1.4%	-0.9%	0.0%	1.6%	1.7%	1.7%	1.7%	1.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Currencies	2.1%	-2.0%	-1.6%	-1.6%	-4.2%	-2.2%	-3.2%	-5.8%	-1.3%	1.5%	1.4%	-1.2%	0.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Natural Gas	-1.4%	-1.8%	6.1%	6.1%	-5.9%	-1.5%	1.1%	-1.0%	1.3%	2.5%	10.8%	3.3%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Gases Comparable Growth %	3.5%	-1.2%	7.3%	6.1%	4.2%	2.7%	1.9%	1.9%	3.3%	3.7%	4.2%	3.3%	4.8%	4.7%	4.9%	4.4%

Source: Air Liquide, Bernstein analysis and estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			30 Sep 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
Al.FP (Air Liquide)	O	EUR	170.88	192.00	(6.1)%	EUR	6.07	6.51	7.17	30.9	28.6	25.1
EDME			1,573.97									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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We value the gas majors on prospective P/E and regard c.28x NTM as appropriate for Air Liquide. This is at a premium to the top end of AL's historical range reflecting the re-rating of the gas majors as the industry has consolidated and seen improved discipline, alongside the attractions of their resilient mix (with a high proportion of protected income) but also long-term growth potential. It also (rightly in our view) represents a modest discount to its closest peer, Linde plc given its stronger earnings potential and discipline. Hence, our PT of €192.

RISKS**Air Liquide SA**

Downside: With a strong focus on performance, any setbacks will likely have an exaggerated impact on the share price (PT impact -€10). Given its high exposure to North America IM sales (c.70% of regional sales) a recession scenario would likely weigh heavily on the share price (PT impact -€10); If IM pricing falters (PT impact -€5); If the project backlog falters (PT impact -€5), especially if uncertainties in the clean hydrogen story see a lack of new signatures here (PT impact c.-€10).

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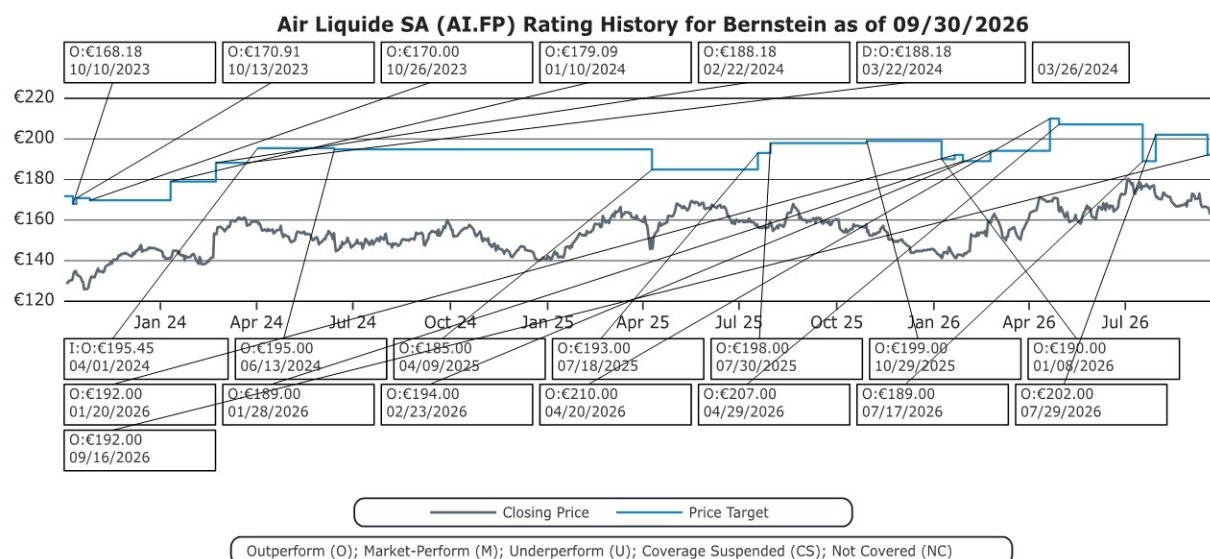
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